



Hospital Wide Guideline

Notifications and Clinical Summaries (NaCS)

Allied Health Practice Guideline #23

Scope

Site	Service/Department/Unit	Disciplines
SCGOPHCG	Allied Health	Dietetics, Occupational Therapy, Physiotherapy, Podiatry, Psychology, Social Work and Speech Pathology

Introduction

Allied Health staff involved in inpatient care may document appropriate outcomes and care plans within the electronic discharge summary known as “Notifications and Clinical Summaries” (NaCS).

Risk Statement

Non-compliance with this guideline will:

Breach legislative requirements	☒	Impact on Patient Quality of Care	☒
Breach National/State/Hospital Policy	☒	Impact on Patient Safety	☒
Breach professional standards	☒	Misconduct	☐
Breach SCGOPHCG Mission & Values	☒	Staff Safety	☐
Other:	☐		

Guideline Details

Allied Health staff may add a short summary to NaCS, particularly for ‘patients of concern’.

NaCS is not a mandatory requirement for Allied Health staff and will not replace the need to complete profession specific iSoBAR clinical handovers for transitions of care.

Allied Health staff are permitted to add content to NaCS in the following areas:

- Allied Health/Nursing section in Clinical Synopsis
- Advice to GP section in Plan
- Advice to Patient section in Plan

Allied Health staff documentation in NaCS must include:

- Full name
- Profession
- Date of entry
- Contact telephone / page number

Entries to NaCS need to be completed during the inpatient admission to ensure the responsible Medical Officer can finalise the discharge summary in a timely way.

NaCS discharge summaries are automatically provided to the GP and the patient. Allied Health staff can add additional recipients such as referring doctors, Aged Care Facilities, Silver Chain and/or other Allied Health likely to be involved in care after discharge.

Any additions made in NaCS after the summary has been sent to the designated GP will require Allied Health to contact the specialty Medical Officer and ask that the summary be re-authorised and re-sent.

Related Policies / Documents

[ICT Core Clinical - ALLIED INFORMATION - NaCS Quick Start Sheet.pdf - Compact Docs Listing \(sharepoint.com\)](#)

[WA Health Clinical Handover Policy](#)

[NMHS Clinical Documentation Policy](#)

[SCGH Clinical Handover Policy](#)

Authorisation

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Policy Contact	Director Allied Health		
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For full details regarding, development, review, consultation, approval, endorsement - contact the Policy Officer for the submission form